



MEMORANDUM

To: Dr. Chris Castille, CEO — GitEnterprises
From: HR Analytics Team
Subject: Recommendation on work-from-home policy
Date: Sample (course use)

Problem

Employees requested a formal WFH policy. Leadership worries about productivity, creativity, and commitment. Assumption: only computer-based roles are eligible; production-line roles stay on-site.

Options — push one

Traffic light: green = accept / recommended · yellow = caution / hybrid · red = decline / status quo.

✓ A	B	C
Enact WFH (eligible jobs) +1% compensation budget ► RECOMMENDED — push this	Hybrid (core on-site days) +1% compensation budget	Do not enact WFH No budget add-on · status quo

What stakeholders stand to gain — or lose

Gain if we adopt a targeted policy: clearer employee response to a formal request, stronger retention/recruitment signal for eligible roles, and a testable pilot before a firm-wide bet. Lose if we reject without evidence: continued friction over flexibility, weaker employer brand for computer-based talent, and no organizational learning about whether remote options help or hurt us.

Line managers gain plain-language performance criteria; they lose unmanaged ambiguity if we adopt without monitoring. Eligible employees gain flexibility and morale upside; they lose if creativity or coordination is punished without clear standards. Non-eligible roles gain equity only if eligibility rules are transparent — otherwise they lose trust.

Research question (PICOC-ready)

In medium-sized manufacturing firms, what is the effect of offering WFH options for computer-based roles on productivity, retention, and recruitment versus not offering remote work?

Teaching note for the simulation: large language models are often good at guessing likely study outcomes. Use Gemini (minimum) and Consensus (preferred for evidence) to anticipate what a policy choice is likely to bring about before — and while — you commit. Then verify every citation.

Evidence (verified)

Consensus synthesis of remote-work studies suggests productivity is generally not harmed when job design and management practices fit. Bloom et al. (2015) RCT: ~13% higher productivity for WFH call-center employees (quieter work, fewer breaks). Textbook synthesis (Bauer et al., 2023) links well-designed remote options to engagement and retention. Creativity/recruitment effects remain less settled — treat as open assumptions to audit.

Recommendation

Enact a targeted WFH (or hybrid) policy for eligible computer-based roles. Limiting eligibility protects production efficiency while answering employee demand. Pair the decision with the audit loop below so we learn whether the policy works as intended in our context — not only in published averages.

Audit ourselves (keep visual, not a wall of text)

Simple four-step check for the next ~3 months. Purpose: see if the policy is working as intended.

1. Question	2. Measures	3. Compare	4. Decide
Is WFH working as intended?	Productivity, morale, turnover, hire quality	Eligible vs on-site; before vs after	Expand · modify · stop

Students may replace this figure with their own compact diagram — creativity welcome if it stays CEO-readable.

AI disclosure

This sample was prepared with AI assistance to structure arguments and summarize evidence patterns. Consensus was used to review empirical findings on remote work and productivity. Claims were checked against cited sources. For your own submitted work, an AI disclosure sentence in the letter is fine; use the BayouPAL AI Disclosure tool when you want extra protection.

[AI disclosure →](#)

References

Bloom, N., Liang, J., Roberts, J., & Ying, Z. J. (2015). Does working from home work? Evidence from a Chinese experiment. *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 130(1), 165–218. <https://doi.org/10.1093/qje/qju032>
Bauer, T. N., Erdogan, B., Caughlin, D. E., & Truxillo, D. M. (2023). *Human resource management: People, data, and analytics* (2nd ed.). SAGE.